Mastery: perks, orders and spells

Levels 6 to 9 of every skill, the twenty mastery orders, the ten mastery spells and the seven Grand Designs

Kingdoms Call reference sheet. Data file v2026.10.15-1202. Generated 2026-10-19 from the repository (branch at that date). Numbers are what the engine uses today, read straight from its tables; where a figure comes from the rulebook text instead, the section says so.

Past level 5 a skill stops growing its base effect and instead grants a perk at 6 and 8 (always on) and a new order or spell at 7 and 9. These levels come only from field experience. The rulebooks may hint at mastery but never name it (R-114), so this sheet is the one place the whole ladder is written out.

What to look for when reviewing

- Are the even-level perks of similar value across skills? Some are precise (Melee 6 Parry), some vague (Spy 8 "your spycraft deepens").
- Do the order hints on the player's form agree with the unlock text? Several differ in the figure quoted.
- Each L7/L9 order is once per turn per character. Mastery spells are once per turn too.
- The Grand Design (Sage 9) is each alignment's Wonder.

Where this comes from

- Data file: MASTERY_UNLOCKS (what the hero is told on reaching the level), SPELL_DEFS_P (reqLevel 7/9), KC_GRAND_DESIGNS.
- Player portal: L79_ORDERS (the order hints). Engine: MASTERY_ORDER_KEYS, war-mastery-orders, espionage-orders.

The mastery ladder, skill by skill

Skill	Level 6 (perk)	Level 7 (order or spell)	Level 8 (perk)	Level 9 (order or spell)
Melee	Parry — in personal combat, each enemy melee blow that lands has a 50% chance to be reduced by 1 up to half your Melee skill.	New order — Challenge: call out an enemy commander in your province to single combat.	Counterattack — in personal combat, when an enemy misses you there is a 50% chance you riposte at once with a free melee strike.	New order — Rampage: after winning a duel, immediately strike a second enemy force.
Archery	Impalement — in personal combat, each arrow that hits has a 50% chance to impale, bleeding the foe 1-3 damage every round for three rounds.	New order — Rain of Arrows: a free pre-battle volley that softens the enemy front line.	Trueshot — in personal combat, each arrow that hits has a 50% chance to strike a vital point, so the foe's very next attack automatically fails.	New order — Sniper's Mark: target an enemy commander before battle for a chance to wound or slay them.
Tactical	Each unit you lead has a 10% chance to fight one experience tier higher in each battle.	New order — Feigned Retreat: bait an attacker, then counter at +strength.	Units you lead are 50% less likely to die or disband after losing a battle.	New order — Grand Stratagem: dictate the terms of one battle.
March	Each army you lead adds +2% exploration to every province you move into.	New order — Forced March: march to an adjacent province with a 50% chance to slip past a battle this phase (once per turn).	All terrain combat bonuses for the units you lead are doubled, and they suffer no terrain penalties.	New order — Lightning Advance: a foe you attack this turn fights with no terrain bonus, no pre-battle magic and no pre-battle archery.
Naval	Moving into a sea province while leading naval units adds +5% exploration to each adjacent land province.	New order — Blockade (needs a fleet): a 50% chance to seal a sea province so enemies may not cross it this turn.	Land units you lead take no penalty fighting at sea, and one naval hull now carries what once needed two.	New order — Raid the Coast (needs a fleet): an amphibious assault launched from the sea at +strength, plundering the province treasury if you capture it.

Skill	Level 6 (perk)	Level 7 (order or spell)	Level 8 (perk)	Level 9 (order or spell)
Sage	Gain +5 gold each time you make a new Sage discovery (discovery chance still caps at 5; your level counts toward the Loremaster title).	New order — Research Breakthrough: a guaranteed Sage discovery this turn.	Each new Sage discovery permanently raises the tax base of the province you are in by +1 (max 10).	New order — Grand Design: realise your alignment's unique realm-wide Wonder.
Spy	Your spy actions now always succeed.	New order — Sabotage: wreck an enemy province (−tax / disband a garrison unit next turn).	Your spycraft deepens — infiltration grows surer.	New order — Assassinate: attempt to kill an enemy hero in a province you have infiltrated.
Thief	A personal stipend adds +5 gold to your income each turn.	New order — Grand Heist: once per turn, crack the vaults of the enemy capital or rich province you stand in — a quarter of that realm's treasury and a magic item off one of their couriers.	Gold you steal with a Grand Heist is doubled — you take the full amount even if the victim cannot cover it — and your own pockets can no longer be picked.	New order — Vanish: nothing can bring you to bay this turn — no pursuit, Encounter or ambush.
Druid	Creature and Monster units you lead cost half to recruit and draw half wages.	New order — Awaken Grove: raise a temporary Creature host from a forest or jungle you hold.	Creature and Monster units you lead fight one experience tier higher in every battle.	New order — Wild Calling: turn a whole wild (Creature or Monster) province's defenders to your side.
Explorer	On entering a province you automatically spot one random undiscovered lair.	New order — Chart the Unknown: fully explore this province and reveal all its neighbours.	Each Explore action has a 50% chance to permanently raise the province tax base by +2 (max 10), once per province.	New order — Discover Lost Ruin: guaranteed to find and reveal a hidden lair or treasure site.
White Magic	Mass Healing — at the end of every turn, all friendly characters sharing your province (you included) heal half their maximum HP.	New spell — Sanctuary: ward a province so enemy armies there fight at −strength.	+10% to your chance to cast ANY spell — stacks with the same L8 perk from your other magic schools (hard 95% cap).	New spell — Divine Judgment: smite a chosen enemy force for heavy holy damage.
Psychic Magic	Words of Awe — your Oratory raises the armies it inspires by TWO quality levels instead of one.	New spell — Mass Confusion: an enemy hero loses their Tactical command in their next battle.	+10% to your chance to cast ANY spell — stacks with the same L8 perk from your other magic schools (hard 95% cap).	New spell — Dominate: seize an enemy hero's orders, turning up to half their armies to your side.
Illusory Magic	Shimmer — enemy players are half as likely to see or find this character.	New spell — Phantom Host: duplicate the monsters and creatures you lead as phantom doubles that fight for the rest of the turn.	+10% to your chance to cast ANY spell — stacks with the same L8 perk from your other magic schools (hard 95% cap).	New spell — Veil: for two phases, you and your armies vanish from enemy sight and hostile magic.
Elemental Magic	Elemental Armour — in combat, every attack that lands on you is reduced by 1-3 HP.	New spell — Chain Lightning: strike several of an enemy hero's units at once.	+10% to your chance to cast ANY spell — stacks with the same L8 perk from your other magic schools (hard 95% cap).	New spell — Cataclysm: devastate a province — heavy damage to every enemy force, and it yields no tax.
Necromancy	The Necromantic Arts — every skeletal army you lead fights one experience tier higher in battle.	New spell — Raise Wraiths: raise the strongest battlefield dead as an elite Wraith whose Wraith's Touch withers the enemy's finest each battle.	+10% to your chance to cast ANY spell — stacks with the same L8 perk from your other magic schools (hard 95% cap).	New spell — Death's Dominion: mass-raise skeletal units from a battle's graves at once.

The twenty mastery orders, as the orders form describes them

Order	Skill	Level	Target	What the form tells the player
Challenge	Melee	7	character	Melee 7: call out a LONE enemy hero in your province to single combat — the loser is wounded, or slain.
Rampage	Melee	9	character	Melee 9: hurl yourself at an enemy force in your province — cut down several of its units and wound its commander.
Rain of Arrows	Archery	7	character	Archery 7: loose a volley on an enemy force in your province, felling several of its units.
Sniper's Mark	Archery	9	character	Archery 9: mark an enemy commander in your province — a telling shot that wounds, and may slay.
Feigned Retreat	Tactical	7	none	Tactical 7: bait your attacker — if you are attacked this turn, your defence counters at +25% strength.
Grand Stratagem	Tactical	9	none	Tactical 9: dictate the terms of battle — your next battle this turn is fought at +20% strength.

Order	Skill	Level	Target	What the form tells the player
Forced March	March	7	province (move_adjacent)	March 7: march to an adjacent province — if an enemy army or a Defend order awaits, a 50% chance to slip in without a battle this phase (the fight comes next phase if you stay, or at turn end).
Lightning Advance	March	9	none	March 9: strike before they can set — enemies you attack this turn lose their defensive footing (−20%).
Blockade	Naval	7	province (sea_adjacent)	Naval 7: seal a sea province you are in or adjacent to — enemy fleets may not cross it this turn.
Raid the Coast	Naval	9	none	Naval 9: an amphibious assault — when you come ashore from the sea this turn and fight for the coast you land on, you hit at +25% strength (the whole landing does, even if another hero takes command of it).
Research Breakthrough	Sage	7	none	Sage 7: a guaranteed scholarly discovery this turn (if any remain undiscovered by your realm).
Grand Design	Sage	9	none	Sage 9: complete your realm’s Grand Design — a unique, once-ever Wonder whose blessing is set by your realm’s alignment.
Grand Design	Sage	9	none	Realise your alignment's Wonder (see below). Hint is written per realm on the form.
Sabotage	Spy	7	province (enemy)	Spy 7: wreck an enemy province you can see — it yields no tax next turn and loses a garrison unit.
Assassinate	Spy	9	character	Spy 9: attempt to slay an enemy hero in the province you stand in — a spy-level chance to kill.
Grand Heist	Thief	7	here	Thief 7 · ONE attempt per thief per turn (spent win or lose). You crack the vaults of THE PROVINCE YOU STAND IN — no hero is targeted. Where: the province must be held by a realm you are AT WAR with, and be their HOME CAPITAL or RICH country (tax 7+). Take: 25% of that realm's treasury (doubled at Thief 8, even past what they can cover) AND one magic item — cut from a courier still on the road inside their realm, from a Send Item order made earlier this turn (a heist never touches what a hero carries in their own pack — that is the Steal order). Odds: 60% +5% per Thief level past 5, halved if the vaults are guarded (a garrison stands there, or an enemy commander of that realm is present with troops). Fail and you are seen unless you slip away (Thief × 20%) — then a hero of that realm draws steel on you (lead with Flee in your Encounter Plan if you would rather not fight), or if none is there the guards beat you off.
Vanish	Thief	9	none	Thief 9: melt into the shadows — for the rest of this turn no pursuit, Encounter or ambush can bring you to bay, and no thief caught in the act can be cornered.
Awaken Grove	Druid	7	none	Druid 7: while in an owned forest, jungle or wild (Creature or Monster) province, raise a temporary Creature host that fights until turn’s end.
Wild Calling	Druid	9	none	Druid 9: while standing in a wild (Creature or Monster) province, call its wild host to your banner — several of its beasts defect to you.
Chart the Unknown	Explorer	7	here_or_adjacent	Explorer 7: fully chart the province you stand in OR one bordering it — 100% mapped, every lair in it revealed, and all ITS neighbours glimpsed at 25%.
Discover Lost Ruin	Explorer	9	lair_tier	Explorer 9: name a class of lair. EVERY lair of that class in your province and in each bordering province is laid bare at once. A rival's Hide Lairs glamour still conceals what it covers.

The ten mastery spells

Spell	School	Level	Target	Effect
Sanctuary	White Magic	7	province	Action (White 7): ward a province you are in or adjacent to. Enemy armies fighting there this turn do so at −25% strength.
Divine Judgment	White Magic	9	character	Action (White 9): smite an enemy hero in your province — heavy holy damage to them, and several of the units they lead are destroyed.
Mass Confusion	Psychic Magic	7	character	Action (Psychic 7): an enemy hero in your province loses all Tactical command in their next battle this turn.
Dominate	Psychic Magic	9	character	Action (Psychic 9): seize the mind of an enemy hero in your province — up to half the armies they lead defect to you.
Phantom Host	Illusory Magic	7	none	Action (Illusory 7): phantasmal duplicates of 15% per caster level (min 1) of the monsters/creatures you lead join your force for the rest of the turn — they fight but never appear in your roster, and melt away if their originals fall or the force is beaten.
Veil	Illusory Magic	9	none	Action (Illusory 9): for this phase and the next, you and the armies you lead vanish from enemy sight and cannot be targeted or affected by any hostile spell.

Spell	School	Level	Target	Effect
Chain Lightning	Elemental Magic	7	character	Action (Elemental 7): arcing lightning tears through an enemy hero in your province — 30% of the units they lead are caught, and each caught unit has a 50% chance to be destroyed.
Cataclysm	Elemental Magic	9	province	Action (Elemental 9): devastate a province you are in or adjacent to — every enemy force there loses units, and the province tax base is permanently reduced to 0.
Raise Wraiths	Necromancy	7	none	Action (Necromancy 7): raise the strongest of your province's battlefield dead as an elite Wraith — whose Wraith's Touch permanently withers a highest-experience enemy unit each battle it fights.
Death's Dominion	Necromancy	9	none	Action (Necromancy 9): the fallen of your province rise en masse — raise several skeletal units at once from its battlefield graves, each risen one experience level higher.

Grand Designs (Sage 9): one Wonder per alignment

Alignment	Wonder	Effect
Divine	Grand Cathedral	Bless costs you no casting slot, and its ward lies permanently over your capital.
Good	Free City Charter	Every province you hold that keeps a garrison yields +2 tax.
Druidic	World-Tree Grove	Your monsters and creatures cost half their wages and muster as Veterans.
Neutral	Grand Library	Your scholars make one guaranteed Sage discovery every turn.
Pagan	Standing Stones	Your armies fight at +25% strength when defending forest, jungle or mountain provinces.
Evil	Iron Throne of Skulls	Enemy units slain in battles you win may rise as your skeletons.
Undead	Deathless Legion	Your skeletal units never disband for unpaid wages, and rise one experience tier stronger.

Rules

Rule	What it is
How it is earned	Levels 6–9 only through field experience (fighting, casting, exploring, leading); never the Practice ground. One rise per phase, one per skill per turn.
Once per turn	Each L7/L9 mastery order may be attempted once per turn per character, spent win or lose. Mastery spells likewise.
Secrecy	The rulebooks hint at mastery but never name a perk, order or spell (R-114). A hero's own report spells it out on reaching the level.
Titles	Every level past 5 counts toward the Imperial Titles.
Cast chance	Each school's L8 perk adds +10% to every cast; the four stack to the 95% ceiling.

Gaps, questions and things to check

These are observations from reading the data files, the engine and the rulebook together. None of them is a ruling. Each is a question for Toby or a place where two sources disagree.

#	Observation
1	Unlock text and form hint disagree on figures: Feigned Retreat (unlock "+strength", hint "+25%"); Grand Stratagem ("dictate the terms of one battle" vs "+20% strength"); Lightning Advance (unlock "no terrain bonus, no pre-battle magic, no pre-battle archery" vs hint "lose their defensive footing (−20%)"); Sabotage ("−tax / disband a garrison unit" vs "yields no tax next turn and loses a garrison unit"); Raid the Coast (unlock "plundering the province treasury" vs hint "+25% strength"). The engine should be read for the truth and both texts aligned.
2	Spy 8 ("your spycraft deepens") and Explorer 6 ("spot one random undiscovered lair") are the vaguest and smallest perks; compare with Thief 8 (double heist gold, pockets cannot be picked) or Tactical 8 (half losses).
3	Sage 6 is +5 gold per discovery and Sage 8 +1 tax base per discovery (R-059): both pay only when discoveries are still being made, so they fade late in a game once the fields run dry (R-037).
4	Druid 6 (half cost and wages for beasts) overlaps the Druidic Grand Design (half wages, muster as Veterans). Stacking order should be stated.

#	Observation
5	Melee 7 Challenge targets a lone enemy hero; Melee 9 Rampage "after winning a duel" (unlock) vs "hurl yourself at an enemy force" (hint). Different triggers.
6	Forced March is described as "with a 50% chance to slip past a battle this phase"; at March 7 a hero already has +3 points from level 5, so the order's worth is the battle-skip, not the move.
7	Grand Heist's hint is the longest single rule text on the orders form (about 150 words). Consider shortening.
8	Naval 8 "one naval hull now carries what once needed two" plus Great Turtles' two berths: check they stack as intended (four units a turtle?).